

L E S S O N 26

Practical Steps to Beat Temptation

11: Victory over Sin

Scripture Focus: 1 Corinthians 10:13 · James 4:7

This lesson continues the victory over sin section with practical help for resisting temptation and pursuing faithful obedience.

BY THE END

You Will...

A	Explain the central discipleship issue in your own words.
B	Connect the main truth to 1 Corinthians 10:13 and James 4:7.
C	Name one way this truth should shape your thinking, obedience, prayer, or witness.

VOCABULARY

Key Terms

THEME	STUDY NOTE
Sin	Any failure to love, trust, worship, and obey God as He deserves; sin separates people from God and requires divine rescue.
Victory	The believer's growing freedom to resist sin and walk in obedience through union with Christ and the Spirit's help.

THEME	STUDY NOTE
Temptation	A test or lure toward sin that must be resisted through Scripture, prayer, watchfulness, and dependence on God.
Faith	Trusting God's Word and relying on Christ rather than self, merit, feeling, or religious performance.
Scripture	God's written Word, authoritative and sufficient for knowing Him, understanding salvation, and walking faithfully.

TEACHING NOTES

I. The Main Question

Christian discipleship begins with learning to see resisting temptation from Scripture rather than from instinct, habit, or surrounding culture. The goal is not simply to collect religious information, but to have the mind, conscience, and affections trained by God's Word. The teaching continues the victory over sin section with practical help for resisting temptation and pursuing faithful obedience.

A growing Christian asks: what does God require me to believe, reject, receive, or practice? Real maturity includes a clearer love for Christ, a humbler view of self, and a more faithful step of obedience.

II. What Scripture Says

1 Corinthians 10:13 and James 4:7 provide the biblical anchor. These passages keep the discussion tied to God's Word and give the learner a stable foundation for reflection. What's amazing is the Bible says God will always forgive us.

Before moving too quickly to application, read the references slowly. Ask what the passage reveals about God, what it says about the human condition, what it commands or promises, and how it points the believer back to Christ. Scripture sets the agenda; Christian reflection follows where God has spoken.

III. The Doctrine Explained

Doctrine matters because discipleship is built on truth. Similarly, in 2 Timothy 2:22, Paul calls Christians to actively flee youthful lusts and instead pursue godly virtues like righteousness, faith, love, and peace. Doctrine is not a detached category for specialists; it names what every Christian is learning to believe, confess, defend, and practice.

Write the doctrine in your own words. Then ask how it fits into the larger story of Scripture: creation, fall, redemption, and Christian growth. A doctrine has been understood more deeply when it begins to reshape worship, repentance, assurance, humility, courage, and love.

SCRIPTURE SPOTLIGHT

1 Corinthians 10:13

1 Corinthians 10:13 should be read as more than a proof text. It gives the subject its center of gravity and keeps Christian thinking inside God's revealed Word rather than personal opinion.

Read 1 Corinthians 10:13 first, then read James 4:7. Notice how the passages work together: one may name the doctrine, another may show its consequence, and another may press the believer toward obedience.

When we read God's word, when we are in the Bible all the time, we will help keep our way pure.

Study the passage:

1. *What does this passage teach about God, Christ, humanity, sin, grace, or obedience?*
2. *What word or phrase should control how you understand this truth?*
3. *How would this passage help a newer believer think more clearly?*

FRAMEWORK

Fighting Sin Faithfully

BIBLICAL RESISTANCE	UNHELPFUL PATTERN
Names sin honestly before God.	Minimizes or excuses temptation.
Uses Scripture, prayer, and accountability.	Relies on willpower alone.

BIBLICAL RESISTANCE	UNHELPFUL PATTERN
Runs toward Christ after failure.	Hides in shame or gives up.

PAUSE & REFLECT

Before moving on, write one sentence answering this: where does resisting temptation most need to become clearer or more obedient in your own life?

IV. Common Confusion

Common confusion usually begins when a biblical truth is reduced to a slogan, separated from its context, or filtered through personal experience. so, as we think through the armor, we now move to another step that's critically important in this battle. New believers especially need help seeing the difference between a biblical category and a half-true assumption.

When confusion appears, do not answer it only with opinion. Return to the text, define your terms, and make careful distinctions. Stability grows as hard questions are brought patiently under Scripture.

V. Why This Matters for Discipleship

Truth becomes fruitful when it forms the disciple. I need a person who's going to challenge me to walk in holiness and godliness. Biblical teaching should train the believer to worship, repent, trust, forgive, serve, pray, resist sin, and speak the gospel with clarity.

Ask where this truth should create maturity. Does it deepen assurance? Correct pride? Encourage obedience? Make Scripture more central? Strengthen witness? The question is not merely whether the content is understood, but what kind of disciple the truth is forming.

VI. How This Changes Daily Life

Resisting temptation belongs in ordinary Christian life, not merely in a notebook. Psalm 119:11 tells us, "I have stored up your word in my heart that I might not sin against you." Scripture renews our minds and helps us discern truth from lies.

Identify one real setting where the truth should matter: a conversation, a temptation, a fear, a decision, a family moment, a church responsibility, or a private habit.

Growing in grace often happens through small, repeated acts of faithfulness. Choose one practice for this week that is concrete enough to obey, simple enough to remember, and biblical enough to strengthen your walk with Christ.

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **resisting temptation should train the way a believer thinks, worships, and obeys.**
- **Scripture must set the terms before personal experience, church culture, or instinct is allowed to define the issue.**
- **Psalm 119:11 tells us, "I have stored up your word in my heart that I might not sin against you." Scripture renews our minds and helps us discern truth from lies.**
- **Christian maturity grows as doctrine moves from information into prayer, repentance, assurance, service, witness, and daily faithfulness.**

REFLECTION

Questions for the Lesson

1. *What should become clearer in your thinking about resisting temptation?*

2. *Where does this truth correct a common misunderstanding or shallow habit?*

3. *What is one concrete step of obedience, prayer, study, or conversation you should take this week?*

PUT INTO PRACTICE

A Discipleship Conversation

Imagine a newer believer asks you about resisting temptation. They are not asking for a lecture; they need a patient, Scripture-shaped answer that helps them trust Christ and take one faithful next step.

Your Task

1. Use 1 Corinthians 10:13 to write a simple, biblical answer in your own words.

2. Name one practical step you would encourage this person to take this week.

3. Write one prayer request that fits the truth and the situation.
